

OLM Open Tools
Distance Gradation
User Manual

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Change Logs

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Figure 1,3,4,5,6,7,9: ©L5/FCIE M 2010

1. Introduction

Distance Gradation is a plugin for Adobe® After Effects® (AE). It will generate gradation inside/outside of mask (alpha channel). It can then be used to create aura or light effects. Also by using black and white gradation inside a mask, it produces depth map that could be used for 2D/3D conversion.



Figure 1 Example of uses of Distance Gradation

1.1. Supported Environment

Please refer to OLM Open Tools [website](#) for a complete list of supported environment.

1.2. Install

The zip archive you can download from OLM OpenTools web site contains the files listed in Table 1. To install OLM Smoother copy the plug-in file (DistanceGradation.aex) in A E plug-in directory.

(ex: C:\Program Files\Adobe\Adobe After Effects 2022\Support Files\Plug-ins\OLM)

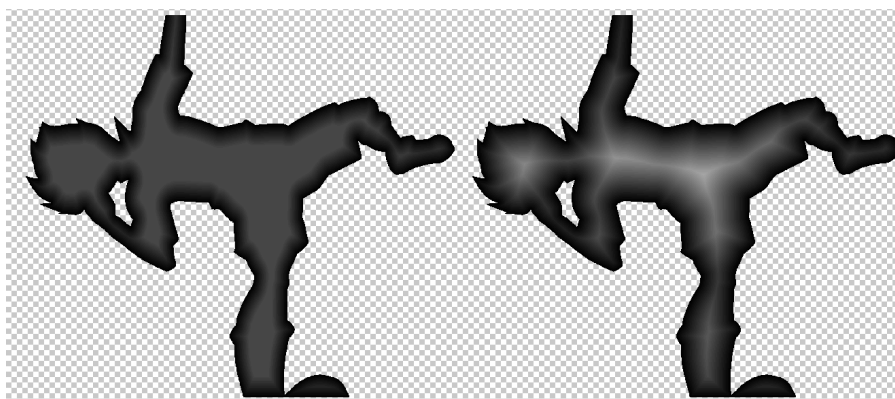
Folder	File Name	Explanation
Plugins\[32/64]\[Version]	DistanceGradation.aex	The plug-in files
Doc	DistanceGradationUserManual.pdf	The user manual for Distance Gradation

Table 1 Content of the zip archive

After Effects plugins from OLM Open Tools use Visual C++ 2019 runtime. They require the installation of Visual C++ Redistributable that supports Visual C++2019. After Effects usually ships with a compatible version, but if the plugin does not work please install the [latest Visual C++ Redistributable](#) yourself.

2. Using Distance Gradation

To apply the effect, use the menu: (Effects)→(OLM Plug-ins)→(Distance Gradation).



**Figure 4 Inside/Outside threshold effect (left:70, right:256).
With small values the overall pictures get dark.**

- **Render Mode** — We can choose between the three following rendering mode (Figure 5).

RGB — Generates a colored picture from the distance. At 0 distance from the mask, Gradation Color will be used, at the maximum distance, Background color will be used. In between, color will be computed according to the interpolation method chosen.

Layer — Use the color from the input image to generate gradation

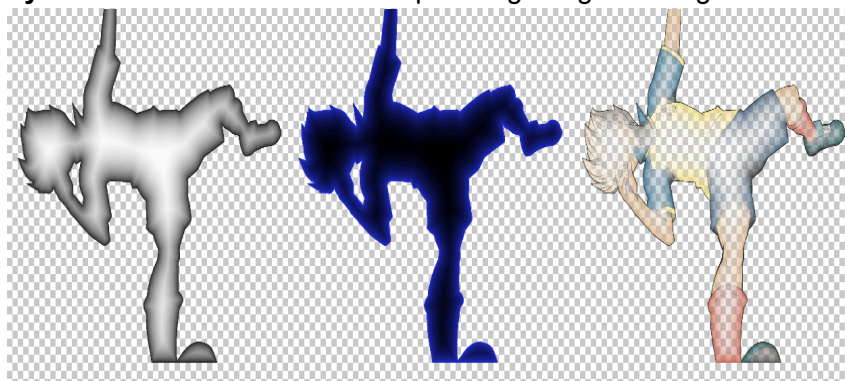


Figure 5 The different render mode (from left: RGB, Layer)

- **Use Background Color** — When off, alpha gradation of the Gradation Color is generated. When on, alpha channel is generated with a value of 1, and BG Color is used to generate the color gradation.
- **Gradation Color** — The color of the gradation
- **BG Color** — When Use Background is ON, is used for the background color.
- **Invert** —When Use Background is OFF, will invert the alpha channel, resulting in transparent alpha close to the mask and opaque alpha far from it. When Use Background is ON, will invert the Gradation Color and BG Color.



Figure 6 Invert On/Off comparison (left: off, right: on)

- **Interpolation Mode** — There is 3 interpolation mode (Figure 7, Figure 8)
Linear—Linear interpolation
Sphere—Interpolate with a sphere-round shape
Power —Interpolate with power function. Uses Power parameter to create sharp shape(Power >1), and round shape (Power <1).
Constant —Fill-up with color without interpolation
- **Power** —This parameter is valid only when Interpolation Mode is Power. Adjust the interpolation shape.

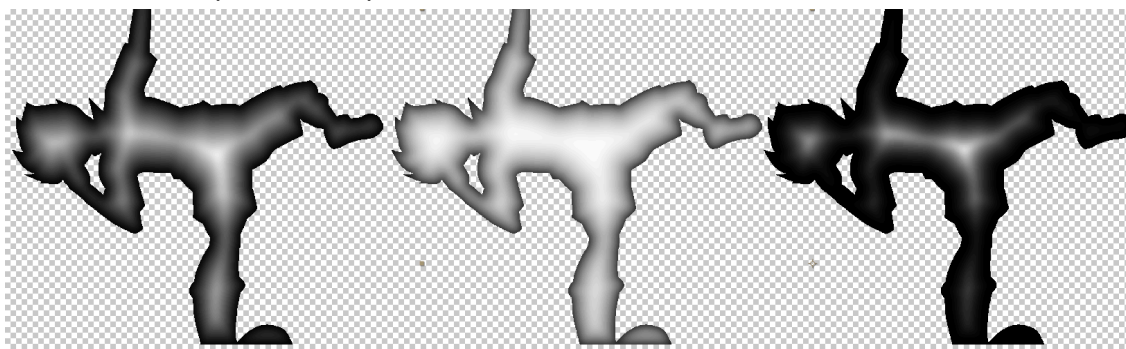


Figure 7 Interpolation Mode comparison
From left: linear, sphere, power (=2.2)

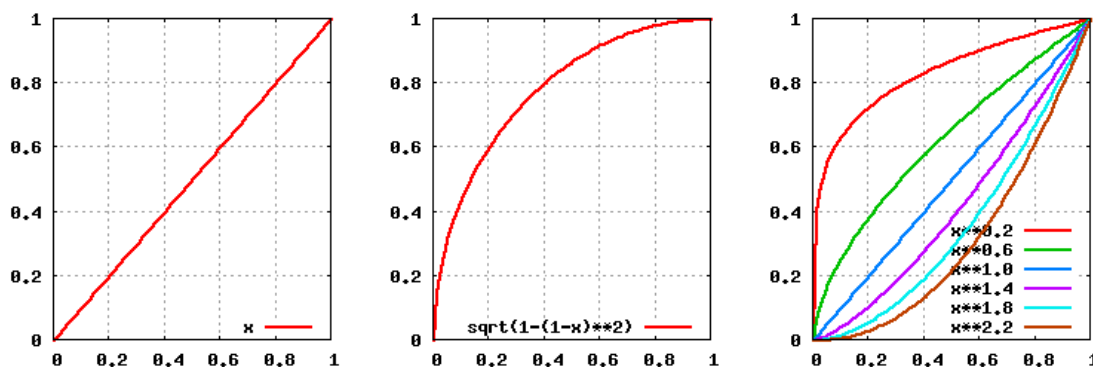


Figure 8 Curve used for interpolation
From left: Linear, Sphere, Power (top= small value, down=high values)

- **Blur Mode** — Defines what kind of blur is applied at post process (Figure 9)
 - No Blur** — no blur applied
 - Blur No Scale** — simple blur
 - Blur** — add some scaling to the blur, keeping more details than simple blur

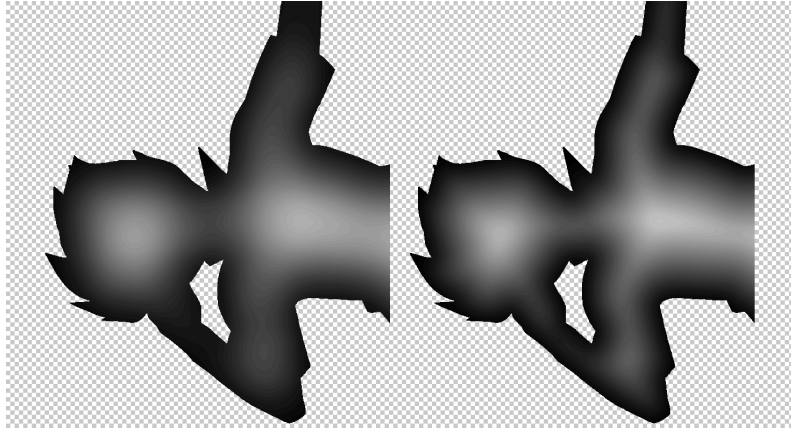


Figure 9 Blur Mode comparison. Left: Blur no scale, Right: Blur

- **Blur Size** — Strength of the blur effect. Bigger value means stronger blur.

4. Others

If you have problem using the plug-in in any environment, if you find a bug, have a feature request, or for any kind of feedback feel free to contact us at the following mail address:
opentools@olm.co.jp